

Side Quests

A last-week incentive programme for creators, priced from our own TikTok revenue data

The proposal in one paragraph

In the last week of each month, a number of our creators sit just short of a threshold that pays LEAP real money — holding their diamond tier, crossing into the next one, or clearing TikTok's activeness gate. Most of them do not know how close they are, and we have never told them.

Side Quests is a card sent on the 23rd that names the target, states the reward, and routes them to their coach for help. If they hit it they keep their normal incentive and receive a top-up in TikTok coins plus an entry to the monthly Uni Wheel.

September, had we run it		
Cards we would have sent	28	to 28 creators across 11 coaches
Value on the board	£3,105	all three TikTok incentives combined
Of which genuinely missed	£1,308	11 creators who fell short
Cost to run, central case	£254	coins plus the Uni Wheel prize
Net, central case	+£139	at a 30% conversion rate

Why this is worth doing

Three things make this different from a normal creator push.

- **The money is already proven.** Every rate in this document has been reconciled to the penny against TikTok Backstage. We are not estimating what a creator is worth — we know.
- **The targets are cliffs, not slopes.** A creator who finishes one diamond short of their tier earns us nothing at all. The same creator one diamond over earns 4% of their entire month. Nowhere else in the business does so little effort move so much money.
- **Nobody is being told.** In September, 33 creators dropped out of their tier. Not one of them was sent a figure, a deadline, or an offer.

How LEAP actually earns

TikTok pays the agency three separate ways. All three are driven by the same diamonds, which is why one creator push pays us three times over.

Incentive	How it is calculated	September
Incremental revenue	Every diamond × \$0.01 × the network rate (8.00% in September)	\$23,210
Activeness	Every diamond × \$0.01 × a rate set by how consistently the creator goes LIVE (2% to 3.5%)	\$8,040
Rank-up and maintenance	Crossing a tier pays 7.5% down to 4% of the creator's whole month . Holding a tier pays a flat 4%.	\$11,200
Total		\$42,400

Both the rank-up and maintenance payments are gated: the creator must reach 7 valid LIVE days and 15 LIVE hours in the month, or they receive nothing regardless of their diamonds.

What the last week of September cost us

September ran with no quests, which means we have a clean record of what happens when nobody is told. Taking every creator's position on the 23rd and following them to the 30th:

What they were short of	Creators	Hit it anyway	Value missed
Holding their diamond tier	45	12	£5,217
Crossing into the next tier	14	6	£951
Clearing the activeness gate	2	1	£123
An activeness level-up	223	173	£49

Holding a tier is the whole opportunity. It accounts for roughly four fifths of everything missed, and it is concentrated in a few dozen people rather than spread across the roster. By contrast, 223 creators sat one or two LIVE days from an activeness level-up and 173 of them got there unaided — that category is worth £49 and we should not run it.

How we choose who gets a card

Four tests, applied automatically on the 23rd of each month:

- **Is there a threshold in front of them?** Hold their tier, cross into the next, or clear the gate.
- **Can they realistically reach it in seven days**, at their own daily rate? This is the most important filter — it cut the September list from 45 candidates to 12, removing people a card would only have annoyed.
- **Is it worth at least £25 to LEAP?** Below that the card is not worth the administration.
- **Have they not already crossed it?**

Tightening the value floor is the dial that controls volume:

Value floor	Cards	Per coach	Board value	Missed value
No floor	91	7.6	£3,373	£1,325
£25	31	2.6	£3,255	£1,308
£50	23	1.9	£2,935	£1,308
£100	10	0.8	£2,008	£906

A £25 floor drops sixty cards and loses seventeen pounds of value. Those sixty were worth about thirty pence each.

The card

Sent on the 23rd, seven days before month end. Plain, specific, and it names a person to ask for help.

SIDE QUEST — @sassygirliexx	7 days left
HOLD YOUR TIER 5 You finished August on 597,613 and you are on 426,135. You need 73,865 more by the 30th to stay in Tier 5. That is about 10,500 a day. Hit it and you get: • your Maintain Incentive as normal — 2,500 coins • PLUS 2,000 coins on top • PLUS 1 entry to this month's Uni Wheel Drop below and you get none of it — Tier 4 pays nothing for maintaining. Need help hitting it? Speak to your coach.	

A worked example

@sassygirliexx is a real creator and September is a real outcome. She finished the month **60,984 diamonds short** of holding Tier 5, having already streamed 20 days and 44 hours. She was not coasting. Nobody told her the number.

If she had held Tier 5	Calculation	To LEAP
Maintenance bonus	$500,000 \times \$0.01 \times 4\%$	£150.81
Incremental revenue	$60,984 \times \$0.01 \times 8\%$	£36.79
Activeness	$60,984 \times \$0.01 \times 2\%$	£9.20
Total earned		£196.80
Her Maintain Incentive (she already qualifies)	2,500 coins	−£25.00
Side Quest top-up at 10%	2,000 coins	−£20.00
Uni Wheel entry	share of one Universe gift	−£0.20
Net to LEAP		£151.60

What actually happened: LEAP received nothing, and she received nothing. Under our current rules a creator who drops below their tier does not qualify for the Maintain Incentive either. Both sides lost.

Costs and returns

The honest difficulty with any incentive is that you must pay everyone who hits the target, including those who would have hit it anyway. On September's board that is £1,797 of the £3,105 — and at a 10% top-up it costs us roughly £180 for nothing. That is the unavoidable price of a programme creators can see and trust.

Conversion rate	Spend	Make	Net
15% of those who fell short	£234	£196	–£38
30% — central case	£254	£392	+£139
50% — optimistic	£280	£654	+£374

Break-even is roughly one in five. If a card persuades one creator in five who would otherwise have fallen short, the programme pays for itself. At one in three it returns about £139 a month on £254 of spend; at one in two, £374.

These figures are deliberately conservative. They exclude the value of a creator who holds their tier in September and therefore starts October in a higher band, and they exclude any effect on retention.

What we do not know

- **We cannot yet measure whether a card changes behaviour.** September ran without quests, so the 15 / 30 / 50% conversion figures are scenarios, not findings. The only way to establish the real number is to run it.
- **The recommended first month is a half-roster test.** Send cards to half the eligible creators and compare the two groups at month end. On September's numbers that costs around £130 and answers the question permanently.
- **Timing is deliberate and based on evidence.** Creators who needed a genuine lift converted at 30% when prompted around the 23rd and at 0% from the 26th onwards. Seven days is late enough to know who is truly at risk and early enough for one more stream to fix it.
- **One rule needs amending.** Our current posters state that rewards do not stack. The Side Quest top-up must sit outside that rule — it is an addition to whichever incentive the creator already qualifies for, not a third competing incentive.

Recommendation

Run it for one month as a half-roster test, from the 23rd of October, at a 10% top-up and a £25 value floor. Expected outlay is under £150. If conversion lands at or above one in five we have a programme that pays for itself and makes LEAP visibly useful to creators at the exact moment it matters; if it lands below, we will know that for the price of a single tier crossing.

All revenue figures are derived from LEAP's daily TikTok Creator data exports and reconciled against TikTok Backstage for September 2026. The three incentive rates, the tier ratios, the flat 4% maintenance rate and the activeness level ratios were each verified against Backstage's own per-creator figures. Conversion rates are modelled, not measured. Coin costs assume £10 per 1,000 coins.